plans for regional integration with the Gulf and Israel, the Gaza War proved a complicating factor.

Vasudhaiva Kutumbakam: G20 and the Global South, 2022–2023

Another major development of the post-Covid period involved a reengagement with the Global South. The idea of the Global South had been popular in historical and developmental circles but not in international relations. But a number of common agenda points began to make themselves felt. The countries of the Global South—despite their many differences—shared colonial histories and belated development trajectories, which together contributed to their marginalization at institutions of global governance. Their economic distress, as a consequence of the coronavirus pandemic, resulted in greater calls for debt sustainability and better representation at international financial institutions. Inadequate climate financing for vulnerable developing countries also led to greater advocacy for climate justice and action. The Russian invasion of Ukraine—coupled with Western sanctions—resulted in more vociferous demands for energy, food, and health security. India shared many similar concerns and saw an opportunity to better position itself as a leader in the Global South. [55]

In part, India sought to elevate its engagement with the Global South through regional summits (as with Africa, the Pacific Island states, ASEAN, or Central Asian Republics). It also opened up new diplomatic missions, including in Africa and Latin America. But concrete contributions often involved India's burgeoning foreign assistance program. Although modest relative to Western donors, India's support for projects in over seventy countries was used to strategically increase goodwill, improve market access, and provide public goods. India's assistance also extended to humanitarian assistance and disaster relief and expanded training programmes, often focused on developing economies. [56] A particular effort that helped to extend Indian goodwill in the Global South involved the Vaccine Maitri initiative, through which India supplied over 300 million